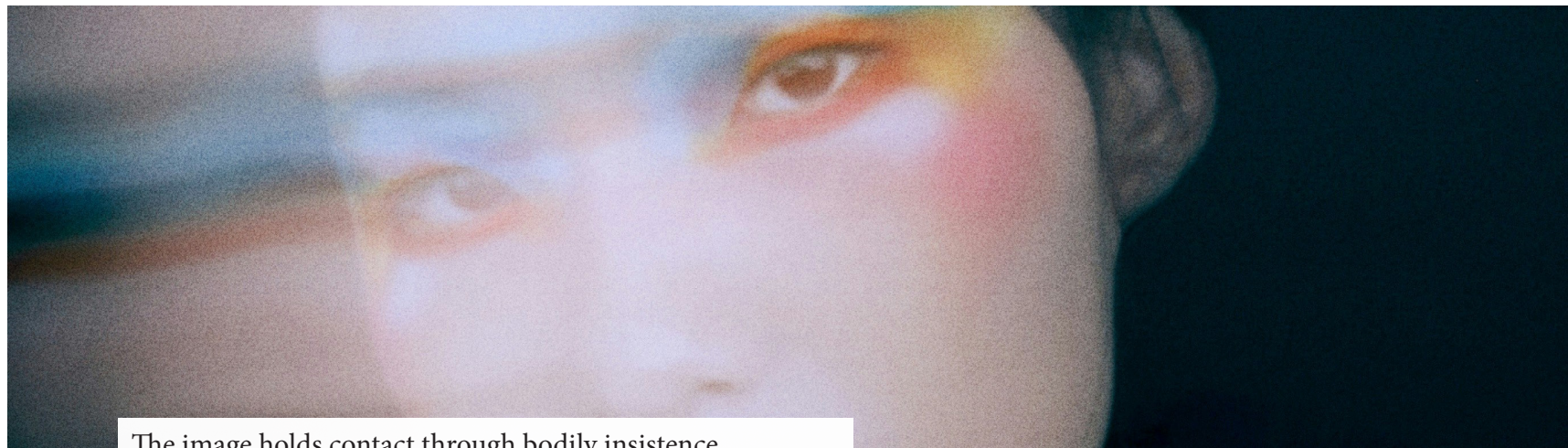




The image holds contact through bodily insistence.

The body arrives before interpretation.

The veil edits attention. The veil is an editing system, not a disappearance. The third movement begins where the body and the rule meet a surface that can

interrupt both. Lace, shadow, fabric, blur, flowers, hair, hands, and darkness all become interfaces. They do not simply hide the figure. They decide how slowly the figure can

arrive. The veiling route is held through iconography, Vera Icona, lace, secrecy, and the larger problem of mediated access. The key point is not that the



A fragment can carry the force of a full figure.

Presence is the first argument.

Presence is the first argument. eye, or a turned face does not wait for culture to explain it. The figure enters as pressure. It occupies the field with the blunt force of being present, and that presence matters because the viewer has not yet been given a stable rule for reading it. McDermott gives this article its earliest time marker: the female body can be read as more than a passive object of display. His argument around Upper Paleolithic figurines opens a different possibility: that bodily representation may also carry evidence of lived

